

Conversation

#08

CONVERSATION

COLLEGE GROUP PROJECT

Teacher's note: get 6 pieces of paper, number them from 1 to 6 and have each student draw one to see which character they will be.

You are a college student and your professor assigned a group project to the class two weeks ago. You have already begun work on the project. Two members from your group will be responsible for presenting the project to the class. You have set a meeting for today to discuss the project because there is still more work that needs to be done.

Teacher's note: All of the names below can be male or female (Pat = Patrick or Patricia / Chris = Christopher or Christina / Sam = Samuel or Samantha / Vic = Victor or Victoria / Val = Valentine or Valerie / Alex = Alex or Alexis).

1. **Pat:** you see yourself as the leader of the group. However, so does **Vic**, and the two of you don't agree on many things. You get along with most people in your group, but you are not happy with **Sam** and **Val** because they are the lazy ones. Both **Sam** and **Val** always have excuses, but the work they were supposed to do hasn't been done yet. This worries you. **Sam** is in charge of Chapter 3 and **Val** is responsible for the illustrations and formatting everything onto PowerPoint for the presentation. You are responsible for writing the presentation and the first chapter, but you need the other chapters in order to finish. Since you are writing the presentation, you believe you should be one of the two people to present the project to the rest of the class next week. Complain to Sam and Val and convince the others that you should present the project.
2. **Chris:** you and **Alex** are friends, and you believe you are the most responsible two in the group because you have both finished your work. You have completed Chapter 2. You and **Alex** want to present the project because you both need the participation points. Defend your work, criticize the others for not completing theirs, and convince the group to let you and Alex present the project.
3. **Sam:** you didn't want to come to this meeting because you know people will say bad things about you since you haven't finished your part — Chapter 3. You have a bit of a bad reputation concerning group work, but you don't feel it's fair. It's true you've had some personal problems lately, but you don't want to go into details with your classmates. You don't care who presents the project. Assure your colleagues that you will finish your work on time.
4. **Alex:** you and Chris are friends, and you believe you are the most responsible two in the group because you have both finished your work. You have completed Chapter 4. You and **Chris** want to present the project because you both need the participation points. Defend your work, criticize the others for not completing theirs, and convince the group to let you and **Chris** present the project.
5. **Vic:** you see yourself as the leader of the group. However, so does Pat, and the two of you don't agree on many things. You are responsible for the most difficult part of the project — the summary. You believe you should at least be one of the two people to present the project because you know a lot about everything due to writing the summary. However, there are still many things missing for you to do your part — the presentation (Pat thinks he/she knows everything, but doesn't) and Chapter 3 (Sam, the laziest of the group). **Alex** and **Chris** have finished their chapters, but you think their work is not very good and you want them to review and improve it. Sometimes you think it would be better if you did all the work — at least that way you'd be satisfied with the project.

6. **Val:** you love computers. That's why you agreed to format the entire project into PowerPoint with illustrations from the web. You plan to use your laptop for the presentation since you will be the one to format everything and know the sequence of slides. It hasn't been as easy as you thought to find good illustrations about your topic, but you are sure you'll find enough before the presentation. Everyone knows that Sam is not doing any work on the project and this worries the group. Explain to Sam that everyone in the group must do their share (like you are doing) and convince the others that you should be one of the two people to present the project.

If time allows: switch characters and repeat the role-play.

Write about a project you were involved in where some people did more of the work than others. Who took the credit? Who was blamed? Etc.

Full Name: _____

Theme:_____

Title: _____

[illegible]